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EXPLAINED

11 September 2026

Onus on Legislature to Make Marital Rape Punishable: SC

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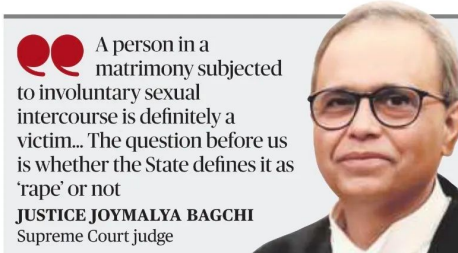
Bench says though it recognises the individual autonomy of married women, both the Indian Penal Code and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita exempt marital rape from being considered a crime

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday guaranteed safety and security to sexually abused married women, but questioned if courts can direct rape prosecutions against husbands when the penal law exempts marital rape from criminal liability.

A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant made a point that though it recognised the individual autonomy of married women, the second exception to Section 375 of the Indian Penal Code (IPC) states that “sexual intercourse or sexual acts by a man with his own wife, the wife not being under 15 years of age, is not rape”.

Section 63 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, which replaced the IPC in 2023, has carried forward the exemption given to marital rape under Section 375 though statutorily raising the age-threshold of the wife to 18.



A person in a matrimony subjected to involuntary sexual intercourse is definitely a victim... The question before us is whether the State defines it as ‘rape’ or not

JUSTICE JOYMALYA BAGCHI
Supreme Court judge

“This is the law as it stands, rightly or wrongly. It is a penal law. Before a constitutional court renders a verdict that the exception is unreasonable or manifestly arbitrary, can we permit a prosecution on that score? Is it within the domain of a prosecutor to prosecute a person when there is a clear exemption under Section 375 or Section 63,” Justice Joymalia Bagchi questioned.

The primary case before the Bench is an appeal filed against a 2022 decision of the Karnataka High Court, which held that a husband could be charged with rape if he had forced himself on his wife. The High Court had relied on the Justice

J.S. Verma Committee report of 2013 which had found the exception regressive. The High Court Bench had observed that “a man is a man; an act is an act; rape is a rape, be it performed by a man the ‘husband’ on the woman ‘wife’”. It had noted that “no exception under law can be so absolute that it becomes a licence for the commission of a crime against society”.

But the Supreme Court questioned the High Court’s logic on Wednesday. “Can a court order prosecution until the constitutional validity of the exception is examined and, if needs be, declared *ultra vires* or read down. It

is the law right now, constitutional or otherwise,” Justice Bagchi debated.

Definition of rape

While Justice Bagchi agreed that a “person in a matrimony subjected to involuntary sexual intercourse is definitely a victim”, he said “the question before us is whether the State defines it as ‘rape’ or not”.

The court mooted that it may be for the legislature to decide if an act should be made a crime.

Senior advocate Indira Jaising, who appeared for the wife in the Karnataka case, said there was enough elasticity to interpret the present law and justify the High Court’s decision to order prosecution for rape. She also noted that the age of consent in Section 63 has been raised from 16 to 18 years.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said the exception for marital rape must continue until the top court took a final call on its reasonableness.

Concept

According to the National Family Health Survey (NFHS-5), around 30% of married women have experienced spousal violence, yet marital rape is still legally exempt. This raises serious concerns about women's rights and equality under the law.

Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS): includes a marital rape exemption in Section 63, which states that sexual acts between a man and his wife are not considered rape if the wife is at least 18 years old. (Earlier 15 years old)

Arguments against the exemption

1. **Article 14:** The non-criminalization of marital rape violates the principle of equality, treating married women differently from unmarried women.
2. **Violation of Article 21:** It disregards a woman's right to personal liberty and bodily autonomy.
3. **Contradiction with POCSO:** Marital rape is criminalised if the wife is under 18, but similar protections are not extended to adult women.
4. **Patriarchal:** The legal exemption reinforces patriarchal beliefs that a wife is the husband's property.
5. **Stigma:** Marital rape victims often face social stigma and are discouraged from speaking out, leading to underreporting.
6. **Mental Health:** Prolonged sexual violence within marriage can lead to severe mental trauma, including depression and anxiety.
7. **Lack of Legal Recourse:** Women have limited options for seeking justice, leading to feelings of helplessness and insecurity.
8. **Global Precedents:** Countries like the UK, Canada, and Australia have already criminalised marital rape.

Arguments for the exemptions

1. **Potential for Misuse:** Criminalising marital rape could lead to false accusations and misuse of the law.
2. **NCRB Crime in India Report 2020:** ~8% of all cases reported for rape were found to be 'false'.
3. **Impact on Marriage:** Criminalization could destabilise marriages and lead to an increase in divorce rates.
4. **Existing Laws:** Some argue that laws like the Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act already address the issue.
5. **Difficult in Proving:** Proving marital rape in a court of law could be challenging due to the private nature of the crime.

Egg, Chicken, Milk Prices: Why They Remain High

Egg, chicken, milk prices: Why they remain high

The two main ingredients in livestock feed — maize and soyabean meal — have seen a sharp cost escalation, with El Niño adding to the problem



HARISH DAMODARAN

IN 2013-14, the gross value added from India's livestock sector was about 34% of that from crops. In 2023-24, the last year for which official data is available, that ratio touched 57%.

Simply put, the value of milk, egg, meat and other animal products from Indian farms is steadily approaching that of crops — be it foodgrains, oilseeds, sugarcane and cotton or vegetables, fruits and spices.

This progress is, however, being undermined by spiralling feed ingredient costs.

Poultry, cattle, buffaloes, sheep, goats and pigs need carbohydrates. It is their principal source of energy, supplied mostly by maize. Broiler chicken feed contains 55-65% maize by weight, with these at 50-60% for egg-laying bird feed and 15-20% in cattle feed.

Carbohydrates apart, livestock require proteins, minerals (such as calcium and phosphorus), vitamins, dietary fibre, fat (oil) synthetic amino acids (methionine and lysine) and other additives. Proteins come mainly from the solid residual cakes/meal after oil is extracted from soyabean, mustard, groundnut, sunflower and cottonseed or rice bran. Broiler feed formulations have 25-30% soyabean meal, while 18-20% for layer feed. Oilseed cakes and meals make up 40-50% by weight in compound cattle feeds.

Soaring costs

The accompanying tables show that the average price of maize at the Alangayam market of Tamil Nadu's Erode district has gone up from Rs 2,537 to Rs 2,759 per quintal between August 2025 and August 2026, and to Rs 2,810 now. The increase is even more pronounced from March 2026.

Prices of soyabean meal (50% protein content) at Madhya Pradesh's Indore, based on quotes at the National Commodity and Derivatives Exchange, have risen from Rs 38,186 per tonne in August 2025 to Rs 58,156 in August 2026. They have fallen to Rs 50,000 per tonne this month, but are still way above the September 2025 average of Rs 35,327.

Average monthly price of maize

	2025	2026
Jan	2,284	2,365
Feb	2,385	2,536
Mar	2,367	1,817
Apr	2,311	1,993
May	2,210	2,038
Jun	2,331	2,160
Jul	2,444	2,653
Aug	2,537	2,759
Sep	2,371	
Oct	2,482	
Nov	2,345	
Dec	2,309	

Price of Maize: Rs/quintal, Erode, Tamil Nadu, spot-indore) Source: CLFMA of India.

Average monthly price of soyabean meal

	2025	2026
Jan	32,441	42,324
Feb	31,149	44,550
Mar	30,218	44,114
Apr	33,747	45,572
May	33,105	61,967
Jun	33,687	61,681
Jul	34,148	62,980
Aug	38,186	58,156
Sep	35,327	
Oct	34,745	
Nov	36,832	
Dec	36,709	

Price of Soyabean meal: Rs/tonne, NCDEX

Monthly average egg prices in Delhi (Rs per 100)

	2024	2025	2026
Jan	605.81	544.68	581.94
Feb	538.41	458.96	502.86
Mar	452.06	421.58	432.77
Apr	396.87	410.77	511.6
May	478.06	488.58	535.16
Jun	480.57	501.8	599.2
Jul	518.23	483.35	670.48
Aug	490.16	509.58	547.32
Sep	538.43	556.03	600.00*
Oct	541.81	573.94	
Nov	602.57	661.07	
Dec	657.1	711.55	

Source: National Egg Co-ordination Committee, *Till Sep 9.

The same goes for other protein sources. Groundnut and rapeseed oilcakes are currently trading at Rs 38,000 and Rs 33,100 per tonne respectively, as against their corresponding September 2025 average price of Rs 24,188 and Rs 24,479, according to the Solvent Extractors' Association of India. So are cottonseed (Rs 35,500 versus Rs 30,500) and rice bran (Rs 20,500 versus Rs 13,669) extractions.

"Soybean meal prices have come off their Rs 63,000-64,000 peak. But just when they are easing, maize prices are hardening. It's almost like a ping-pong game being played," noted Divya Kumar Gulati, chairman of CLFMA (formerly Compound Livestock Feed Manufacturers Association) of India.

The impact

The effects are already visible.

Egg prices in Delhi are at Rs 600 per 100 pieces, as per the indicative poultry farm-gate rates set by the National Egg Co-ordination Committee (NECC). Retail prices are ruling at Rs 7-9 per egg, depending whether they are purchased in 30-piece crates, dozens or smaller lots.

Egg demand and prices generally go up post-Diwali, with the setting in of winter and through the spring season. They drop with the rising temperatures and humidity levels over the summer and early monsoon

Unusual demand

Egg demand and prices generally go up post-Diwali, with the setting in of winter and through the spring season.

This year, prices scaled Rs 725-730 per 100 eggs even in July, with the average of Rs 670.5 a whopping 38.7% higher than last year.

months. The real dip happens in the festival period — from *Shravan* (end-July to early-September), *Pitru Paksha* (late-September to early-October) and Navratri (mid-October), to Diwali and Chhath Puja (early to mid-November) — when many Hindu households avoid eggs.

This year, the NECC-suggested prices scaled Rs 725-730 per 100 eggs even in July, with the average of Rs 670.5 a whopping 38.7% higher than last year (see table). "Many things came together. The extended summer and delayed monsoon rains due to El Niño caused water shortages, leading to heat stress and rising bird mortality rates. Also, July witnessed a spike in both maize and soyabean meal prices," explained Sanjeev Chintawar, chief operating officer of NECC.

While egg prices have since softened, thanks to the onset of *Shravan*, the feed cost challenge remains. "In the last four months, layer feed prices have climbed from Rs 24-26 to Rs 30-32 per kg. Feed constitutes 65-70% of the farmer's egg production cost," added Chintawar.

Farmgate broiler chicken prices, too, hit Rs 150-plus per kg of live weight across North India in late-June/early-July. Post *Shravan*, they have settled at Rs 115-120 per kg. "Broiler feed prices have surged from Rs 40 to Rs 46/kg over the past four months, shrinking the profit margins of farmers.

Their total production cost now is roughly Rs 110 per kg," said Ricky Thaper, joint secretary of the Poultry Federation of India.

Farmers raise day-old chicks weighing 35-45 gm to 2-2.5 kg slaughter-ready broiler birds over 35-42 days. The cycle is longer for layer hens. These begin laying eggs at 18-20 weeks of age and do so until they are 70-72 weeks old. Each bird lays 250-300 eggs annually.

Looking ahead

Soyabean meal prices have come down somewhat in the last couple of weeks.

This is partly because farmers have sown almost the same area under soyabean in the current *kharif* (monsoon) season as last year. The condition of the crop, due for harvesting in October-November, is also said to be normal to good so far, with no major insect pest or disease incidence being reported.

El Niño's impact has been less in soyabean relative to other crops, which require more water and fertilisers. Further, some large Indian poultry companies with captive feed manufacturing facilities have contracted soyabean imports, which are estimated at 0.9 million tonnes (mt) in 2025-26 (October-September). It has improved the carryover stocks and likely availability for the new marketing year.

"Our greater concern is maize, where *kharif* acreage is significantly down (4.1%, going by government data) and the yield outlook isn't also encouraging. Moreover, El Niño could hurt the prospects for the *rabi* (winter-spring) maize crop," CLFMA's Gulati pointed out.

The US Department of Agriculture has projected India's maize production in 2026-27 at 50 mt, a sharp decline from the record 55.1 mt of 2025-26, which itself was a substantial jump over the preceding year's 43.4 mt.

With sugar prices on the boil, the Narendra Modi government is expected to restrict mills from using any cane juice or high sucrose 'B-heavy' molasses for manufacturing ethanol in the upcoming crush-year beginning October.

If maize prices continue to rise — spilling over into livestock feed costs and ultimately what consumers pay for milk, eggs and meat — there could be a review of even diversion of the feed grain for ethanol production. That would make meeting the existing 20% blending in petrol (E20) itself difficult in 2026-27.

Concept

- **A structural shift:** The livestock sector's share of India's gross value added from agriculture rose from about 34% in 2013-14 to 57% in 2023-24 the value of milk, egg, meat and other animal products is steadily approaching that of crops.
- **The feed squeeze:** This progress is being undermined by spiralling feed-ingredient costs; livestock need carbohydrates (mainly maize) and proteins (mainly soyabean meal, alongside groundnut, mustard and cottonseed cakes).
- **The price spike:** Maize at Tamil Nadu's Erode market rose from ₹2,537/quintal (Aug 2025) to ₹2,810 now; soyabean meal at Indore jumped from ₹38,186/tonne to a peak of ₹63,000-64,000/tonne, though it has since eased.
- **Impact on consumers:** Delhi egg prices hit ₹670.5 per 100 (about 38.7% higher than last year); farmgate broiler chicken prices touched ₹150+/kg live weight in North India, before softening somewhat after Shravan, a period when many Hindu households avoid eggs and meat.
- **Why El Niño matters:** Extended summer and delayed monsoon rains caused water shortages, heat stress and rising bird mortality; El Niño has hurt maize more than soybean, since soyabean needs comparatively less water and fertiliser.

Did OpenAI Solve the Navier-Stokes Problem?

OpenAI's claim of Navier-Stokes breakthrough has sparked controversy after Tristan Buckmaster alleged that its internal model arrived at the exact approach he and Levent Alpoge had been pursuing; questions remain over whether OpenAI trained on private Codex data, the proof's validity and who deserves credit

OpenAI's claim of Navier-Stokes breakthrough has sparked controversy after Tristan Buckmaster alleged that its internal model arrived at the exact approach he and Levent Alpoge had been pursuing; questions remain over whether OpenAI trained on private Codex data, the proof's validity and who deserves credit

FULL CONTEXT

Yasudevan Mukunth

The story so far:

The image is a horizontal composite. The left half features a network graph with nodes of various colors (blue, orange, green, red) connected by thin grey lines. The right half shows a dense, complex mesh of grey nodes and lines, representing a fluid dynamics simulation. Below the mesh, there is a small text box with a red arrow pointing to it.

What is the Navier-Stokes problem?

The Navier-Stokes equations describe the motion of viscous fluids like water and air, and they have frustrated mathematicians and physicists for more than two centuries.

As OpenStax wrote on its website: "The Navier-Stokes equations use Newton's second law of motion ($F = m \times a$) to describe how fluids move. Importantly, they treat a fluid as a continuous medium rather than tracking individual molecules. These equations are used for aircraft design, weather forecasting, and the study of blood flow."

The Clay Mathematics Institute in New York lists a problem about the equations as one of the seven Millennium Prize Problems. That is, anyone who can prove whether the equations always have smooth, predictable solutions or whether the equations can “blow up” – meaning the mathematical solutions reach infinity in finite time – will win \$1 million and considerable respect in the mathematics community.

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While OpenAI has said its agents reached a solution for the Navier-Stokes regularity problem in 88 hours, it is unclear who, if any, outside the company has seen the claimed 100-page proof. [Source: @AI/ML/LLM/AGI](#)

generated by models like Anthropic's Claude and OpenAI's GPT-5.6 Sol – and checked by a computer to make sure the mathematics were correct.

However, the raw output from the AI route he and Alpöge had been pursuing. Buckmaster also wrote that he and Alpöge had been logging their work on OpenAI GPT-5, a tool to translate natural language prompts into code, for months.

employee of Anthropic. OpenAI's rival, Buckmaster said he refused both offers and threatened to go public with the conversation, whereupon Buckmaster allegedly responded: “Why would you

What is a forcing function?

The Millennium Prize problem statement, authored by U.S. mathematician Charles Feferman, offers a few avenues for a valid proof. Options A and B deal with unforced equations, while Options C and D allow for a solution that includes an external forcing function.

A forcing function is an external influence that adds momentum to the fluid, e.g., you dip your spoon into a bowl of water and stir it. A forced blow-up would be when you keep stirring the fluid harder and harder until the equations predict the flow becomes infinitely violent in a finite amount of time – as if you were stirring at nearly the speed of light.

September 3, after hearing OpenAI was investigating the rumors, Buckmaster emailed a prominent mathematician at OpenAI. This information comes from a statement that Buckmaster published on his university website.

Buckmaster said he clarified that his work with Alpêge was in a personal capacity and did not represent an

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What is the data-access issue?
Buckmaster's public statement has already triggered scrutiny of OpenAI's corporate practices. When it claimed to have solved the same formulation of the problem Buckmaster and Alpêge had been working on, Buckmaster asked how the AI model had arrived there. On the

While OpenAI has said its agents reached a solution in 88 hours, it is unclear who, if any, outside the company has seen the claimed proof. Since Buckmaster described the AI-generated paper as "silly," it is unknown whether OpenAI's internal model actually produced a rigorous proof or a convoluted approximation.

For such a blow-up to qualify for the Millennium Prize under Options C and D, the force causing the blow-up can't suddenly appear/disappear or change abruptly from one place or time to another. It must obey the usual laws of physics.

But on September 4, OpenAI posted a "status update" with Buckmaster's institutional effort by Anthropic and that the duo planned to publish its results once it had finished polishing the manuscript. The (unnamed) interlocutor at OpenAI replied expressing excitement.

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September 6 call, Bubeck allegedly admitted an entire team had been assigned to crack the problem.

Further, Buckmaster said he had been imparting all of his and Abjoke's drafts on GPT-4 over a year. So, when Buckmaster contacted GPT-4 last November about OpenAI's internal model on privacy?

The silence regarding whether OpenAI trained its internal model on Buckmaster's private Codex logs has been deafening.

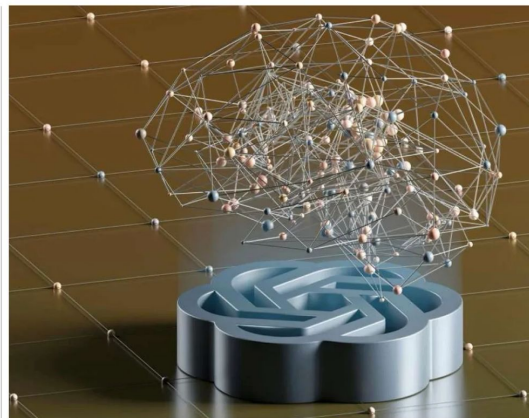
Who deserves the credit? The AI research community?

Over the last year, New York University mathematician Tristan Buruckmaster and Anthropic researcher Levent Alpoge have been using AI models to use a technique developed by Spanish mathematicians Diego Córdoba and Luis Martínez-Zoza to show that forward flow causes the Navier-Stokes equations to become singular in finite time.

useful. This route is a niche vector of attack; mathematicians agree it is not possible to arrive at by feeding the problem to an AI chatbot. This detail matters to what followed.	Buckeb dropped a bombshell: an internal OpenAI model had produced a proof of finite-time blow-up for the forced Navier-Stokes equations. Buckeb begged for details, the	in the first, Buckmaster would post his significant result and OpenAI would post their Navier Stokes result the following day. The second was that Buckmaster would write a 6-to-10 page presentation
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How did OpenAI get involved?

How the options got involved: Buckmaster and Alpoige made a breakthrough on August 15. A week later, the duo had their proofs – heavily



While OpenAI has said its agents reached a solution for the Navier-Stokes regularity problem in 68 hours, it is unclear who, if any, outside the company has seen the claimed 100-page proof. GROWTH/UNSPLASH

generated by models like Anthropic's Claude and OpenAI's GPT-5.6 Sol – checked by a computer to make sure the mathematics were correct.

However, the raw output from the AI was practically unreadable. Buckmaster later admitted to later editing the output, but he insists that the "horrendous I have ever read." So Alpage's response was to ask the AI to "edit" the output around the clock, to translate the AI output into a readable paper.

Over the next week, Alpage continued circulating that Anthropic had solved a major open problem in mathematics. On September 4, Alpage posted a tweet investigating the rumors. Buckmaster's response was a promise to publish the OpenAI. This information comes from a statement that Buckmaster published on

Buckmaster said he clarified this work with Alpoge was in a personal capacity and did not represent an institutional effort by Anthropic and that the duo planned to publish its results once it had finished polishing the manuscript. (The unnamed interlocutor at OpenAI replied: expressing excitement

But on September 10, 2013, a subpoena requested a same-day meeting with Buckmaster, which Buckmaster deferred to the following week (i.e., the current week). The day after that, on September 11, 2013, Buckmaster requested a meeting, so Buckmaster said he joined a call with OpenAI computer scientist Sebastian Bubeck and another representative. Alibek did not attend the meeting.

According to Buckmaster, Bubeck also joined into Codes over a year ago. So far, Buckmaster said if the Internal OpenAI model had been trained on or had access to his private Codes sessions, OpenAI could have learned "not to lose the codes." But when Buckmaster pressed on whether his data had been used to train the model that worked on the problem, OpenAI said no.

According to Buckmaster, Bubeck also joined into Codes over a year ago. So far, Buckmaster said if the Internal OpenAI model had been trained on or had access to his private Codes sessions, OpenAI could have learned "not to lose the codes." But when Buckmaster pressed on whether his data had been used to train the model that worked on the problem, OpenAI said no.

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During this call, Buckmaster said Bucked dropped a bombshell: an internal OpenModel had produced a proof of the Navier-Stokes existence and uniqueness theorem. Buckmaster pressed for details, but the only revelation was that the proof was exactly "Existence of forced flows in R^3 and T^3 , with the forcing function in C^{∞} and the velocity field in C^{∞} ." Buckmaster, the exact mathematical

route he and Alpöge had been pursuing. employee of Anthropic, OpenAI's rival

At this point, Buckmaster refused to cooperate with OpenAI and rushed to publish his and Alpøge's results, plus his public statement.

OpenAI subsequently held a press briefing in which it claimed 10,000 AI agents had cracked the problem in an 88-hour marathon that had cost the company millions of dollars.

What is the data-access issue?

Buckmaster's public statement has already triggered scrutiny of OpenAI's corporate practices. When it claimed to have solved the same formulation of the problem Buckmaster and Alpöge had been working on, Buckmaster asked how that model had arrived there. On the September 6 call, Buckmaster allegedly admitted an entire team had been assigned to crack the problem.

While OpenAI has said its agents reach a solution in 88 hours, it is unclear why, outside the company, anyone has been able to see the solution's proof. Since Buckmaster described the AI-generated paper as "slop," it is also unknown whether OpenAI's internal model actually produced a rigorous proof or a computer-aided approximation.

Did OpenAI breach user privacy? The silence regarding whether OpenAI trained its internal model on

Further, Buckmaster said he had been putting all of his and Alpöge's drafts into Codex over a year. So when Buckmaster asked if the internal OpenAI model had been trained on or had access to his private Codex sessions, OpenAI said the model "did not look up user data", but that Buckmaster pressed on, asking whether his data had been used to train the model that worked on the problem, OpenAI didn't answer.

According to Buckmaster, Bubeck also offered him two unethical proposals. In the first, Buckmaster would post his significant result and OpenAI would post their Navier-Stokes result the following day. The second was that Buckmaster would write a solo paper presenting the Navier-Stokes result and acknowledge the internal OpenAI model.

Bubeck reportedly asserted on the call that he wanted Alpöge removed from authorship because Alpöge is an

employee of Anthropic, OpenAI's rival

Buckmaster said he refused both off and threatened to go public with the conversation, whereupon Bubeck allegedly responded: "Why would you ruin your career?" and "If you don't want me to be nice, then I don't have to be nice."

Bubeck has since publicly called the allegations against him "false and inflammatory".

What questions remain?

1. Did OpenAI actually solve the problem?

While OpenAI has said its agents reached a solution in 88 hours, it is unclear whether any, outside the company has seen the claimed proof. Since Buckmaster described the AI-generated paper as "slop", it is also unknown whether OpenAI's internal model actually produced a rigorous proof or a convoluted approximation.

2. Did OpenAI breach user privacy? The silence regarding whether OpenAI trained its internal model on Buckmaster's private Codex logs has been deafening.

3. Who deserves the credit? The AI agents? OpenAI the corporation? Buckmaster and Alpöge? Or Diego Córdoba and Luis Martínez-Zorúa? Indeed, Buckmaster wrote in his statement he believes "Luis

just before the controversy broke out. Fields Medal winner Terence Tao had published a series of notes about why a theorem, mathematically speaking, was wrong.

the age of AI. As he wrote: "The point remains that there is a substantial opportunity cost in converting a historically productive and motivating problem ... into a mere viral social media post advertising some benchmark progress, rather than actually advancing

progress, rather than actually advancing the field and developing the next generation of both problems to ask and people to work on them."

THE GIST

The Navier-Stokes equations describe fluid motion and form one of the seven Millennium Prize Problems, with a \$1 million prize for a valid solution

Buckmaster and Alpöge used AI models to develop a proof of finite-time blow-up involving a forcing function, then worked to turn the AI-generated output into a readable paper

OpenAI later said 10,000 AI agents had solved the problem in an 88-hour effort, while Buckmaster alleged that OpenAI made questionable proposals over publication and authorship.

Concept

- **The controversy:** A potential solution to one of mathematics' greatest open problems has been overshadowed by allegations that OpenAI used its computing power and potentially the private user data of academic researchers to scoop a solution to the Navier-Stokes equations problem.
- **What is the Navier-Stokes problem:** The Navier-Stokes equations describe the motion of viscous fluids like water and air, used in aircraft design, weather forecasting and blood-flow studies; it is one of the Clay Mathematics Institute seven Millennium Prize Problems, carrying a \$1 million prize for proving whether the equations always have smooth solutions or can 'blow up' to infinity in finite time.

Orangutan Rescue: Wildlife Crime Experts to Join Probe

Orangutan rescue: wildlife crime control experts to join probe

Satyasundar Barik

BHUBANESWAR

The Special Task Force (STF) of the Odisha Police on Wednesday began a probe into the circumstances surrounding the rescue of five young orangutans from a coastal forest in Balasore district.

The Odisha Forest and Environment Department has also approached the Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB), seeking its expertise in investigating

cases involving the illegal trafficking of wild animals.

Orangutans are not native to India. The five young apes – three males and two females – were mysteriously found in a casuarina plantation in the Udayapur-Talsari forest area on Tuesday.

Odisha Forest and Environment Minister Ganesh Ram Singhkhuntia said a thorough investigation had been initiated into what appeared to be a case of wildlife smuggling.

Concept

WCCB is a statutory multi-disciplinary body under the MoEFCC.

The Bureau has its

**five regional offices at Delhi (headquarters), Kolkata, Mumbai, Chennai and Jabalpur; and
five border units at Ramanathapuram, Gorakhpur, Motihari, Nathula and Moreh.**

Under the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972, WCCB is mandated to

- **Collect and collate intelligence related to organized wildlife crime;**
- **Disseminate the same to State and other enforcement agencies so as to apprehend the criminals;**
- **To establish a centralized wildlife crime data bank;**
- **Coordinate actions by various agencies in connection with the enforcement of the provisions of the Act;**
- **Assist international organizations & foreign authorities to facilitate wildlife crime control;**
- **Capacity building of the wildlife crime enforcement agencies;**
- **Assist State Governments to ensure success in prosecutions related to wildlife crimes; and**
- **Advise the Government of India on issues relating to wildlife crimes.**

It also assists and advises the Customs authorities in inspection of the consignments of flora & fauna as per the provisions of Wild Life Protection Act, CITES and EXIM Policy governing such an item.

India Has to Act on Its 'Sugar' Problem

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This week, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), prodded by the Supreme Court, proposed a simple but overdue idea. Packaged foods high in fat, salt, or sugar should carry a bold red warning on the front of the pack, not buried in fine print on the back. Someone picking up instant noodles, a breakfast cereal, or a “health drink” will finally be told, at a glance, that it is not as wholesome as its advertising claims. This is a welcome step. It is also, on its own, nowhere near enough.

The number of children presenting with morbid obesity and diabetes has climbed sharply within just a few years. The World Obesity Atlas 2026 bears this out – 41 million Indian children and adolescents aged 5 to 19 are now overweight or obese. This is not just because children are eating more; it is about what they are being sold. Breakfast cereals, sweetened yoghurts, and “health drinks” are marketed to parents as filling gaps in a child’s diet, emphasising “energy” and vitamins while saying little about the sugar content inside. In 2024, a leading multinational was found adding sugar to infant food sold in India and other lower income countries; sugar was left out of the same product in Europe. When a health drink, popular in Indian homes, turned out to be nothing more than flavoured sugar syrup, it took a social media storm, and not a regulator, to force the company to prescribe a 15% cut in its added sugar.

The problem is worse around schools and colleges, where studies show that the cheapest, most easily



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When the U.K. introduced its soft drinks industry levy, sugar consumption fell. Manufacturers reformulated their drinks to slip below the tax threshold rather than raise prices

available snacks are also the least healthy. A popular “energy drink” among teenagers, priced at just ₹20, packs close to 17 grams of sugar, caffeine, and artificial colour into a single bottle. Its label says it is not meant for children, yet nothing stops a child from buying it. This is the market pricing unhealthy calories to fit within the range of a child’s pocket money.

Need for enforcement

None of this is a secret. What has been missing is enforcement. The FSSAI and the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) have long recommended what schools should not sell, but optional rules get treated as optional, and canteens stock whatever sells cheapest. A red warning label only works if it is actually enforced.

Moreover, the new rule stops at the edge of organised retail. Most of India’s sugar, salt, and trans fat is eaten unbranded, from street stalls, dhabas, and sweet shops that make up the unorganised sector, none of which is required to declare anything. A red label on a biscuit packet does nothing about the jalebi sold loose beside it. Regulation that reaches only packaged food leaves the unregulated half of the plate untouched.

Then there is the conversation India keeps avoiding – a tax on sugar. When the U.K. introduced its soft drinks industry levy, sugar consumption among both children and adults fell. Manufacturers reformulated their drinks to slip below the tax threshold rather than raise prices. A well-designed sugar tax does not just discourage people from buying a product, it pushes the industry to make the

product itself less harmful.

India already taxes sugary drinks heavily; just not usefully. Since September 2025, aerated and sweetened beverages, sugar free versions included, were folded into one 40% GST slab – so a “normal” cola and its zero-sugar counterpart pay the same tax, leaving manufacturers with no reason to cut sugar. The U.K.’s levy worked differently, taxing drinks in tiers by sugar content, so that companies could lower their bill by reformulating the product. India could tax products in the same way so that manufacturers have a reason to cut sugar.

The standard objection – that such a tax would hit the poor the hardest – is not wrong, but it is only half the argument. Unregulated, cheap sugar already extracts a heavy price from the poor, who bear the brunt of the diabetes, hypertension and childhood obesity epidemic that sugar heavy diets drive, with the least means to treat it. Doing nothing is not neutral; it is a slower, costlier tax, paid in ill health rather than rupees at the till. The answer is to design the tax calibrated to sugar content so that it nudges reformulation, with part of the revenue set aside to make healthy food cheaper.

The FSSAI’s proposed red label is a genuine, if belated, first step. What India needs now is the resolve to finish what it has started – mandatory food standards; limits on how unhealthy food is marketed to children; rules that reach the unorganised sector; and an honest debate on taxing sugar in a way that protects families with the least room to absorb either cost, the tax, or the disease.

Concept

- **The trigger:** The FSSAI, prodded by the Supreme Court, proposed that packaged foods high in fat, salt or sugar carry a bold red front-of-pack warning, instead of fine print buried on the back.
- **The child-health crisis:** The number of children presenting with morbid obesity and diabetes has climbed sharply; the World Obesity Atlas 2026 finds 41 million Indian children and adolescents (aged 5-19) are now overweight or obese.
- **The marketing problem:** Breakfast cereals, sweetened yoghurts and 'health drinks' emphasise 'energy' and vitamins while saying little about sugar content; in 2024, a leading multinational was found adding sugar to infant food sold in India while leaving sugar out of the same product in Europe only a social media storm forced a 15% cut in added sugar.
- **The pocket-money problem:** The cheapest, most accessible snacks near schools are often the least healthy; a popular ₹20 'energy drink' packs about 17 grams of sugar, caffeine and artificial colour, labelled 'not meant for children' yet freely bought by them.
- **Enforcement gap in schools:** FSSAI and the CBSE have long recommended what schools should not sell, but these optional rules are treated as optional, and canteens stock whatever sells cheapest.
- **Enforcement gap in unorganised sector:** A red label only works on packaged food; most of India's sugar, salt and trans fat is consumed unbranded, through street stalls, dhabas and sweet shops, none of which is required to declare anything.
- **The sugar tax conversation India avoids:** The UK's tiered soft drinks levy (by sugar content) pushed manufacturers to reformulate drinks and cut sugar consumption; India's flat 40% GST on all aerated/sweetened beverages since September 2025 (sugar-free versions included) gives manufacturers no similar incentive to cut sugar.

Behind the UK Ban on Goods from Illegal Israeli Settlements

Behind UK ban on goods from illegal Israeli settlements in West Bank

Moinuddin Ahmad

New Delhi, September 9

THE UNITED Kingdom on Tuesday announced that it would ban all imports originating from illegal Israeli settlements in the occupied West Bank. Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband said the British government believed there was “ethnic cleansing” of Palestinians in areas of the West Bank, perpetrated by “settler terrorists”. He called Israel’s occupation unlawful and a clear attempt to bury the two-state solution.

The decision will prohibit the entry into the UK market of all agricultural, processed, and manufactured goods produced within Israeli settlements across the occupied West Bank, including East Jerusalem. Settlement goods exported to the UK represent a niche segment of total UK-Israel bilateral trade, of about £6.2 billion annually.

British firms will also be barred from providing corporate services that facilitate settlement expansion. The UK will also refuse licence applications for arms and other exports that “materially contribute to the occupation.”

Miliband’s speech was followed by a joint statement by 12 countries, including Canada and France, supporting the two-state solution, and backing restrictions on

West Bank settlements

Area A

Area B

Area C

E1 corridor

Jerusalem



trade with illegal Israeli settlements.

Response to Israel’s proposals

The UK’s decision is considered a response to Israel’s approval of new construction projects in sensitive zones, notably the “E1 corridor” between East Jerusalem and the Ma’ale Adumim settlement. Construction in E1 would sever the territorial link between the northern and southern West Bank,

What is the E1 corridor?

• The E1 corridor is a 12 sq km-stretch of land in the occupied West Bank, located between East Jerusalem and the Israeli settlement of Ma’ale Adumim.

• Construction in E1 would sever the territorial link between the northern and southern West Bank, and further isolate East Jerusalem from the rest of the West Bank, further altering the territories claimed for a Palestinian state.

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The West Bank was partitioned under the 1995 Oslo II Accord into Areas A, B, and C. Area C, comprising roughly 60% of the West Bank, remains under complete Israeli control and houses virtually all Israeli settlements in the West Bank outside Jerusalem. Further into the territory, Israeli agricultural settlements heavily dominate the Jordan Valley and Dead Sea Basin, which cover nearly 30% of the West Bank.

Over time, Israel has allowed the conversion of Palestinian land into industrial date plantations and commercial farms.

The E1 Corridor and Ma’ale Adumim, located east of Jerusalem, link Jerusalem to the Jordan Valley. Settlement expansion here would physically disconnect East Jerusalem from its Palestinian hinterland (Ramallah and Bethlehem).

The Ariel Salient and Barkan Industrial Zone, located in the northern West Bank (Salfit Governorate), cut across major Palestinian agricultural communities and sit atop the Western Aquifer Basin, one of the region’s main water resources. Also, Gush Etzion and the South Hebron Hills (Masafa Yatta) in south Jerusalem disrupt Palestinian pastoral livelihoods through mili-

tary firing zones, outpost proliferation, and land confiscation.

Products, value, and impact

Settlement production relies heavily on commercial agriculture and light manufacturing in designated industrial zones.

Major agricultural goods include Medjool dates, table grapes, herbs, citrus fruits, avocados, and wine (produced in wineries across the West Bank and Golan Heights). Plastics, textile products, construction materials, cosmetics with Dead Sea minerals, and packaging are manufactured within settlement industrial parks.

The ban is not expected to dent Israel’s \$500 bn economy, which is driven by high-technology exports, advanced defence hardware, and pharmaceutical products manufactured within Israel’s pre-1967 lines.

However, it may cause direct financial distress for specialised settlement businesses, through increased operational costs and liability for Israeli firms that source components or raw materials from across the Green Line. Between 2015 and 2020, settlements in Area C and occupied East Jerusalem contributed \$30 billion annually to Israel’s economy, according to a 2022 United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) report.

Thank You,